



ALFRED "THE GREAT"
871-99

The only English king to be known as "The Great", Alfred was almost overthrown by Viking raiders but fought back, captured London, and expanded his original Wessex kingdom.



CANUTE
1016-35

This Viking king treated Danes and Saxons fairly and the country prospered. There is an old story that he proved he was an ordinary man by trying and failing to make the tide go back.



HAROLD II
1066

Harold II was appointed by his brother-in-law Edward the Confessor but his reign was short-lived. He died after being shot in the eye in the Battle of Hastings, and William I took the throne.

1066-1154

NORMANS

Originally Vikings who had settled in northwest France, the Normans were hungry for new land. William the Conqueror claimed the throne after he defeated Harold II at the Battle of Hastings. The Normans built castles and brought with them a feudal system of lords, who held land, and peasants, who worked it.

1066-87	WILLIAM "THE CONQUEROR"
1087-1100	WILLIAM II
1100-35	HENRY I
1135-54	STEPHEN



WILLIAM "THE CONQUEROR"
1066-87

Called "The Conqueror" because he conquered England, William was crowned king on Christmas Day 1066. He built the Tower of London and ordered a survey of land and people called the Domesday Book.

1399-1461

LANCASTRIANS

These three kings reigned through almost continual warfare. French territory was recaptured and then lost, and in the War of the Roses, the royal houses of Lancaster and York fought over the throne for 30 years.



HENRY V
1413-22

Henry V reclaimed lost territories in France when he defeated the French at the Battle of Agincourt, losing only 400 English lives.



HENRY IV
1399-1413

Returning from exile in France, Henry IV reclaimed the throne from Richard II. His reign was marked by many rebellions and revolts.

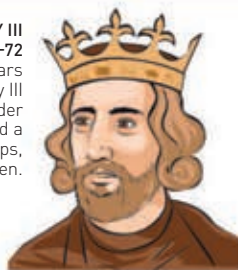


EDWARD I "LONGSHANKS"
1272-1307

This warrior king fought many battles to unite England and Scotland. A model parliament was formed during his reign.

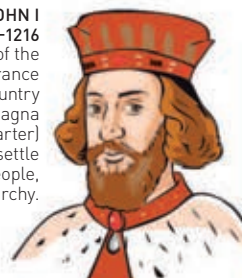
HENRY III
1216-72

After provoking civil wars with his barons, Henry III was defeated by their leader de Montfort, who formed a parliament of lords, bishops, knights, and freemen.



JOHN I
1199-1216

John lost most of the territories in France and taxed his country heavily. The Magna Carta (great charter) was drawn up to settle the rights of people, Church, and monarchy.



1154-89	HENRY II
1189-99	RICHARD I "THE LIONHEART"
1199-1216	JOHN I
1216-72	HENRY III
1272-1307	EDWARD I "LONGSHANKS"
1307-27	EDWARD II
1327-77	EDWARD III
1377-99	RICHARD II

1154-1399

PLANTAGENETS

Originating in Anjou, France, this dynasty took its name from a yellow flower (*Planta genista*) an ancestor wore in his hat. During much of their rule, England was at war with France and Scotland, and Wales and Ireland came under English rule. The Plantagenets laid the foundation for law and government by creating justices of the peace and the first parliament. They put the royal seal on a charter of rights called the Magna Carta.



RICHARD I
"THE LIONHEART"
1189-99

This crusading king spent most of his reign fighting for Christianity in the Holy Lands. Imprisoned by the Emperor of Germany, he was returned for a huge ransom and was eventually killed in France.

1901-10

SAXE-COBURG-GOTHA

This dynasty of just one king is named after Queen Victoria's husband Prince Albert, who was the son of the Duke of Saxe-Coburg and Gotha. Edward became king at the age of 59 and reigned during the first years of the 20th century, when new inventions like the first automobile were taking Britain into the modern age.



GEORGE III
1760-1820

The Americans won independence and England fought France in the Napoleonic Wars during George's reign.



VICTORIA
1837-1901

This much-loved queen ruled for 64 years. After her husband Prince Albert died, she went into mourning but was coaxed back to public life.



EDWARD VII
1901-10

Edward was a social king who enjoyed sports, parties, and travel. He helped restore relations between France and England and built a new royal estate in Sandringham, Norfolk.



WILLIAM IV
1830-37

Many more people got the vote under William IV, and slavery was abolished throughout the British Empire.

1910-

WINDSORS

George V changed his surname to Windsor during the World War I because of the strong anti-German feelings of his people. After Edward VIII gave up the throne to marry a divorced woman in 1936, his younger brother George VI was King through World War II. Queen Elizabeth II has reigned for more than 60 years.

1910-36	GEORGE V
1936	EDWARD VIII
1936-52	GEORGE VI
1952-	ELIZABETH II



GEORGE VI
1936-52

George VI was a good athlete and soldier, but this shy man with a stammer had not expected to be king. He managed to overcome his speech impediment and became popular during and after the war.



ELIZABETH II
1952-

The current queen remains head of the Commonwealth (former colonies) and is popular around the world. Prince William and Catherine, Duchess of Cambridge, and their children lead a new generation of royals.